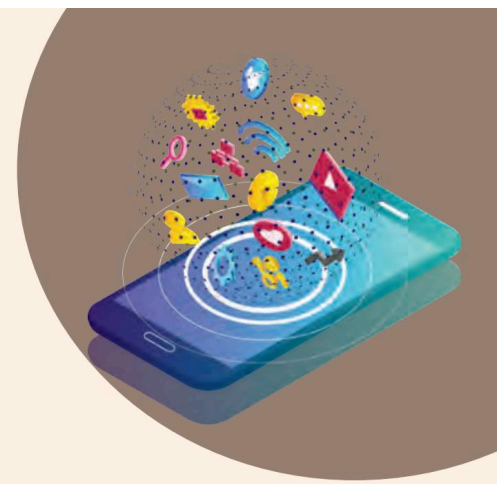


13



Environmental Balance

All facets of our lives are influenced by the environment around us, and all our daily actions also have an impact on the environment as well. We rely heavily on the community of plants (flora) and animals (fauna) to provide us with food and other resources necessary for our survival.

Environment

The word “environment” comes from the French word “environ” which means “to surround”. It includes the surroundings or conditions in which all living organisms exist.

The environment can be classified into two types:

1. **Natural Environment:** It includes all the living (biotic) components like plants, animals, birds, insects; and non-living (abiotic) components like water, air, soil, and sunlight, which occur naturally on Earth. Both the components are dependent on each other for their survival.
2. **Man-made Environment:** It includes the components and structures created by humans to satisfy their needs and requirements like buildings, houses, schools, parks, markets, roads, factories, etc. These components are affected by physical, social, biological and cultural factors.

The natural environment provides humans with resources that they require for their growth and development. The natural environment offers all essential elements necessary for human life such as sun, soil, water, and air.



Society and Environment

There is a strong relationship between our society and the environment. They interact and influence each other in multiple ways. This kind of interaction affects the ecological balance.

Humans depend on the natural resources for fulfilling their basic needs like food, water and shelter. With the increase in population, human beings have modified their surroundings according to their needs and economic benefits. These modifications have impacted significantly on our natural environment. Industrial development and the exploitation of natural resources, like the extensive use of fossil fuels, deforestation etc. have created an imbalance in the environment. People do not use natural resources judiciously and thus it has caused a scarcity of these resources. It is important to strike a balance between both the components to avoid harmful consequences.



Ecosystem

An ecosystem is formed when the living (plants, animals, and other organisms) and the non-living components (air, water, sunlight, soil, weather, temperature etc.) interact and co-exist with each other in a physical environment. These biotic and abiotic components are interdependent on each other. All the organisms play a specific role in an ecosystem and every ecosystem is unique in itself.



Roles of Organisms in Ecosystem

Organisms in ecosystems have diverse roles:

1. Producers (like plants) create energy via photosynthesis.
2. Consumers eat other organisms as herbivores, carnivores, or omnivores.
3. Decomposers (bacteria, fungi) break down organic matter, recycling nutrients.
4. Detritivores (e.g., earthworms) accelerate decomposition.
5. Predators regulate prey populations, maintaining balance.
6. Prey species develop adaptations to avoid predators.
7. Herbivores impact on plant distribution and structure.
8. Pollinators aid in plant reproduction.

Factors That Cause an Imbalance in the Environment

In the present scenario, with increasing population, urbanisation, economic growth and the self-centred approach of humans, resources are not being used judiciously.

This has caused irrecoverable loss to the environment and created an imbalance in the ecosystems.

Overexploitation of Resources With the increase in population, human beings have started to exploit natural resources at a fast pace. This is a huge threat to biodiversity and has resulted mainly in the extinction of species, further affecting, directly or indirectly, the ecological cycle of the environment.

Deforestation Deforestation, or the thinning of forests, is one of the largest issues. This includes the removal of trees for wood products, grazing lands, and creating huge buildings in the name of development. This is a serious environmental concern as it can result in the loss of the natural environment, damage the homes of animals, and create disturbances in the water cycle.



Pollution Pollution can harm human health and the environment in many ways. Pollutants can be found in water, air, and soil. Also, there are different kinds of pollution that impact on the environment in various ways. There can be various causes of pollution like the burning of fossil fuels, smoke from industries and factories, improper industrial waste disposal, increasing number of vehicles on roads, mining etc.

Overpopulation Due to the rapid increase in population, resources are being over-utilised and production of waste is also high. People make extensive use of plastic which is harmful for marine life, street animals and also disrupts food chains, thereby, impacting on the environment.

Global Warming Due to the increase in greenhouse emissions, temperatures are rising, glaciers and polar ice caps are melting, and various species are becoming extinct. The level of carbon dioxide and other harmful gases like methane, nitrous oxide etc. in the air is increasing which also leads to depletion of the ozone layer.

Climate Change Human activities, particularly the burning of fossil fuels, contribute to the release of greenhouse gases, leading to global warming and climate change. These have far-reaching impacts on ecosystems and weather patterns.

Water Scarcity Overuse and contamination of water resources can lead to water scarcity, which has a cascading effect on ecosystems, agriculture, and human populations.

Loss of Biodiversity The extinction and decline of species due to habitat loss, pollution, climate change, and other factors can disrupt ecosystem dynamics and reduce overall resilience.



Did You Know?

Humans use only 1% of the abundant water that is available on the Earth.

Natural Resources

Natural resources are the resources drawn from nature like water, land, soil, rocks, forests, animals, fossil fuels, or minerals which are used by humans to meet their needs and requirements. These resources can be consumed directly or indirectly and can be in any form, such as solid, liquid, or gas. Various types of natural resources are land resources, forest resources, water resources, mineral resources, food resources, and energy resources.

Conservation of Natural Resources

The act of protecting and managing natural resources so that everyone will benefit from them including current and future generations is referred to as the conservation of natural resources. The necessities for our survival are gifts from nature and cannot be substituted. Resource management is another aspect of conservation that aims to stop resource exploitation, deterioration, and destruction. Less waste should be produced, and the resources should be used wisely.

We should try and follow the three R's and contribute towards the environment.

Reduce: We should be mindful of what we are buying and not stock up on unnecessary things. It is an effective way to save resources. Avoid the use of plastic and any such products which have a negative impact on our environment.

Reuse: Instead of throwing away items or discarding them, we should reuse them creatively. For example, glass jars can be used for storing things, old clothes come in handy when you need to clean your home etc. You can share your old things with those who need them.

Recycle: Recycling is a way to reduce our carbon footprint (total amount of greenhouse gases generated by any of our activities). Cans, paper products, glass etc. are all recyclable materials. They should be separated from non-recyclable materials while disposing of them. Community recycling efforts should also be encouraged.



Reduce



Reuse



Recycle



Think and Tell

1. Think about a few steps that you practice in your daily life to preserve the environment.
2. Think about a few steps which you can practice as a community to conserve and protect our environment.

Environmental Protection and Conservation

Environmental conservation is a practice to protect the environment and manage natural resources for the present and future use. Humans should pay attention to their activities and ensure that they do not adversely affect the environment in any way.

A few steps to conserve the environment are:

1. More and more trees should be planted everywhere especially in the areas where forest cover is decreasing due to human activities. They are called life-savers as they convert the excess carbon dioxide in the air to oxygen which is important for our survival.
2. Saving water resources is another important aspect of environment conservation. Turn off the taps when not in use, repair leaky faucets, and install water-efficient appliances.
3. Discharge only clear water into the rivers after treating sewage. Waste from the industries should not be directly disposed of in water bodies as it pollutes the water.
4. To save resources or energy, they must be used effectively. Switch off lights, fans, TVs, and other electrical items when not in use.
5. Use energy efficient bulbs and tube lights that save energy rather than normal filament bulbs.
6. We can use energy-saving strategies, such as cleaning the dust from the tube lights to increase light, routinely servicing and maintaining home appliances etc. Saving money and fossil fuels are additional benefits of energy conservation.
7. Use renewable sources of energy like solar, wind, water, geothermal etc. as they can be replenished over a period of time. Non-renewable sources of energy have a limited supply and cannot be readily replenished.
8. Use public transport, bikes, carpools, bicycles etc. to travel from one place to another instead of personal vehicles. It will reduce your carbon footprint.



9. Create awareness about environmental protection and conservation in your community. Learn about environmental issues and share information with each other.
10. Make sustainable choices in your daily life and encourage others to do the same. Even individual actions can be multiplied and you can contribute to a healthier planet.

Activity Time

Activity 1: Poster Making

(Group Work)

Divide into groups of five. Each group will create a poster on how to conserve the environment. Once completed, every group will present it in front of the class.

Activity 2: Group Discussion

(Group Work)

Divide the class into groups of four. Every group will discuss any one of the following topics:

- The impact of the deteriorating environment on the lives of human beings.
- Various factors that impact on our environment.

Chapter Checkup

A Select the correct option.

1. Why should we conserve our natural resources?
 - a All living beings can benefit from them
 - b They are being depleted at a fast rate
 - c To make the resources available for present and future generations
 - d All of the above
2. Which factor has caused an imbalance in the environment?
 - a Pollution
 - b Wise use of resources
 - c Rainwater harvesting
 - d Forests
3. 'Environment' is derived from which French word?
 - a environ
 - b environ
 - c envron
 - d envirn

B Fill in the blanks with the most suitable words.

1. The clearing or thinning of forests is called
2. The increase in greenhouse gases leads to the depletion of the layer.
3. An is formed when living and non-living components interact with each other in a physical environment.
4. Make choices in your daily life and encourage others to do the same.

C State whether the following is *True* or *False*. Correct the statements that are false.

1. Water pollution is caused by throwing waste into the waterbodies.
2. We should throw away or discard items after using them.
3. Pollution can harm human health in many ways.
4. Discharge dirty water from the industries directly into the rivers.

D Answer the following questions. (Solved)

Q1. Define ecosystem.

A1. An ecosystem is formed when living (plants, animals, and other organisms) and non-living components (air, water, sunlight, soil, weather, temperature etc.) interact with each other in a physical environment. These biotic and abiotic components are interdependent on each other. All the organisms play a specific role in an ecosystem and every ecosystem is unique in itself.

Q2. What are the two types of environment?

A2. The environment can be classified into two types:

- **Natural environment:** It includes all the living (biotic) components like plants, animals, birds and insects, and non-living (abiotic) components like water, air, soil, and sunlight, which occur naturally on Earth. Both the components are dependent on each other for their survival.
- **Man-made environment:** It includes the components and structures created by humans to satisfy their needs and requirements like buildings, houses, schools, parks, markets, roads, factories etc. These components are affected by physical, social, biological and cultural factors.

Q3. Reema, who resides in Wazirabad, has decided to start an 'Environmental Protection Club' with her friends in her society. List a few steps that she can take to make other people aware of ways to conserve the environment.

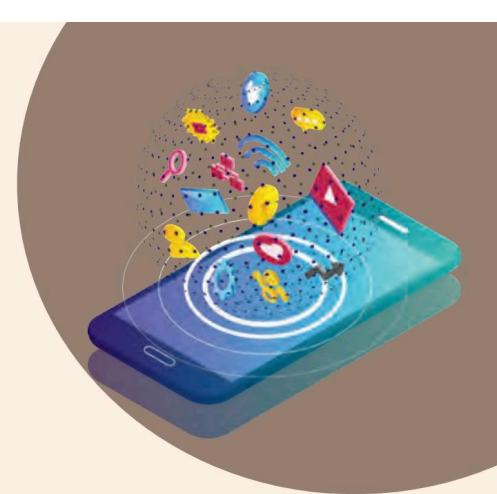
A3. Ways to conserve the environment are:

- More and more trees should be planted everywhere especially in the areas where forest cover is decreasing due to human activities.
- Turn off the taps when not in use, repair leaky faucets, and install water-efficient appliances.
- Use public transport, bikes, carpools, bicycles etc. to travel from one place to another instead of personal vehicles.
- To save resources or energy, they must be used effectively. Switch off lights, fans, TVs, and other electrical items when not in use.
- Use energy-efficient bulbs and tube lights that save energy rather than normal filament bulbs.

Answer Key

- A** 1. d 2. a 3. b
- B** 1. deforestation 2. ozone 3. ecosystem 4. sustainable
- C** 1. True.
2. False. Instead of throwing away or discarding the items, we should try to use them in a creative way.
3. True.
4. False. Discharge only clear water into the rivers after treating sewage.

14



Green Economy

Earth is said to be the only known planet that can sustain life. This is because of its natural environment. But sadly, our environment is at great risk because of the growing population and the rapid consumption of natural resources. With increasing urbanisation, industrialisation, and commercialisation, natural resources are being severely depleted. Mankind has been ungrateful to nature in their usage of natural resources. Thus, various adverse effects have become prominent in the natural environment.

The environment and human activities are closely linked, as one impacts on the other. Human activities like the burning of fossil fuels, forest fires, and poor waste management affect the environment and cause climate change, which in turn causes serious threats to human life. Thus, it is highly important to foster the attitude of love and care for the environment, which can be achieved by developing **green skills**.

Green skills are the knowledge, abilities, values, and attitudes needed to live, flourish in, develop, and support a society that believes in preserving and conserving resources for the future through their optimal and efficient utilisation. The need to transition towards more environmentally sustainable modes of living has become a necessity for developed as well as for developing countries.

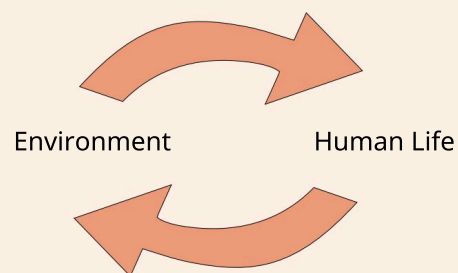
Due to the pace at which we are consuming and exploiting our resources, the world has begun to witness scarcity of many resources. Keeping in mind the lurking environmental threat, environmental scientists are advocating the need to make a shift towards **green economy**.

Green Economy

Green economy is a kind of economy that aims to establish a system that balances human well-being and economic growth while reducing environmental risks and replenishing our resources. The core objective is to promote a sustainable mode of production and consumption without causing any harm to the environment.

The United Nations Environment Program (UNEP), a global organisation that works under the United Nations, defines green economy as “one that results in improved human well-being and social equity while significantly reducing environmental risks and ecological scarcities. It is low carbon, resource efficient, and socially inclusive”. It aims at sustainable development.

The term “green” in green economy refers to the environmentally friendly and sustainable practices it promotes. Its principle is growth, balance, renewal, and sustainability. The emphasis is on reducing waste, conserving resources, and adopting clean technologies. In essence, it is all about finding innovative and sustainable ways to live, work, and produce goods and services that are kinder to our planet.

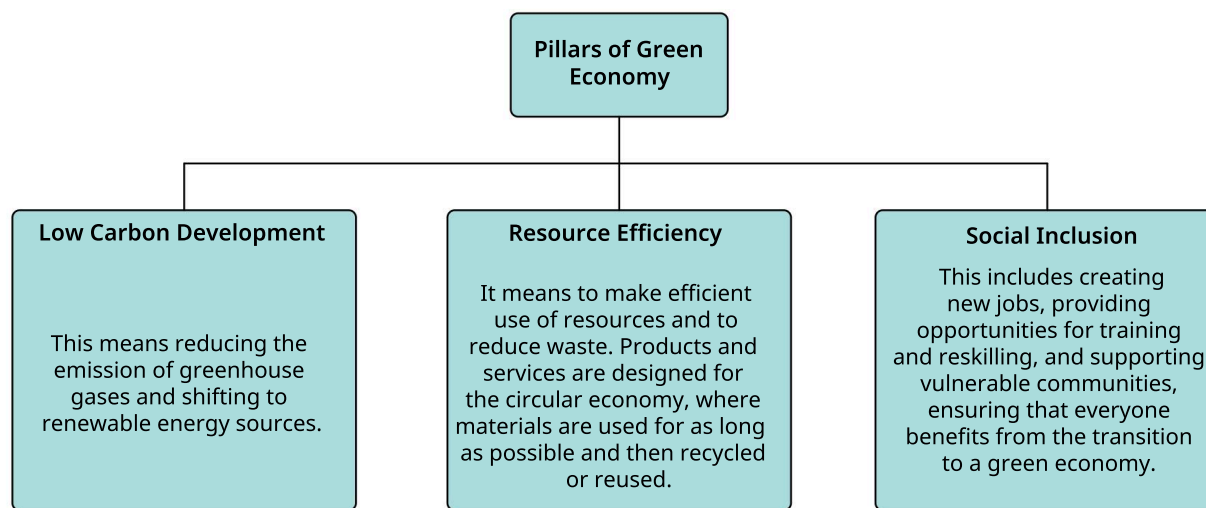




Remember

Sustainable means meeting the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.

There are three pillars of a green economy:



These three pillars are interconnected. For example, low-carbon development can lead to efficient utilisation of resources and their circulation in the economy, since the enterprises invest in innovative technologies and processes to reduce their emissions. This will enable new training and creation of new jobs and thereby, inclusion of the people in society.



Did You Know?

There is another intriguing concept gaining momentum worldwide—the Blue Economy. It focuses on promoting sustainable approaches in relation to our oceans, seas, and coastal areas. Its goal is to safeguard marine ecosystems and leverage their potential for economic growth.

Importance of Green Economy

The green economy is important for a number of reasons:

1. **Mitigating Climate Change:** Climate change is one of the most pressing concerns being faced by humanity today. A green economy can help to reduce greenhouse gas emissions that would impact on climate change.
2. **Protecting the Environment:** The green economy aids the sustainable use of natural resources and the protection of biodiversity. This is crucial for ensuring the well-being of our planet.
3. **Creating Job Opportunities:** The transition to a green economy is expected to create myriads of new jobs in various sectors, like waste management, renewable energy, and resource management. This, in turn, will boost economic growth.
4. **Improving Public Health:** Air pollution caused through burning of fossil fuels is a major cause of respiratory and other health problems. A green economy can help to reduce air pollution and improve the quality of life on Earth.
5. **Reducing Poverty and Inequality:** A green economy can create new opportunities for people in marginalised communities. It can also help to reduce the cost of living for everyone by making energy and transportation more affordable.
6. **Ensuring Economic Stability:** Green economy can lead to more stable economic conditions by reducing the exploitation of resources and price fluctuations. This will also reduce the cost of living associated with environmental degradation.
7. **Innovation and Technological Advancement:** Striving towards green economy encourages innovation in technology and sustainable practices, leading to economic growth and competitiveness in a fast-evolving global market.
8. **Consideration of Moral Ethics:** Adopting sustainable and responsible ways of producing and consuming aligns with ethical values and responsibility towards future generations.
9. **Better Resilience to Challenges:** As the world faces challenges like climate change, resource scarcity, and biodiversity loss, a green economy provides a proactive approach to adapt to and curb these challenges effectively.



Did You Know?

A study by the International Labour Organization found that the transition to a green economy could create up to 24 million new jobs globally by 2030.



Think and Tell

Could there be any drawbacks in the shift towards green economy? In your opinion, do the benefits of green economy outweigh these drawbacks?

Green Economy and India

In India, there is a growing emphasis on embracing the principles of a green economy, placing significant importance on achieving sustainable development and transitioning towards cleaner energy sources.

1. **Renewable Energy:** India has set ambitious targets for renewable energy deployment, and has made significant progress in recent years. The country is now one of the leading markets for solar and wind power.

2. **Energy Efficiency:** India is also investing in energy efficiency measures to reduce its energy consumption. This includes programs to promote energy-efficient appliances and buildings.
3. **Sustainable Transportation:** India is promoting electric vehicles and other sustainable modes of transportation. The country is also investing in public transportation and infrastructure for pedestrians and cyclists.
4. **Sustainable Cities:** India is developing sustainable cities that are more energy-efficient, less polluted, and more livable. This includes initiatives to promote green buildings, waste management, and public transportation.
5. **Sustainable Agriculture:** India is promoting sustainable agricultural practices to reduce its environmental impact. This includes initiatives to reduce pesticide use, improve water management, and promote organic farming. Programmes like PM KUSUM Yojana and Gobardhan Yojna are supporting green farming and sustainable practices in villages.

The transition to a green economy is creating new jobs and opportunities in India. The Indian government has estimated that the green economy could create up to 50 million new jobs by 2030.

Error Alert!

Green Economy is Expensive

There is a misconception that shifting to a green economy is excessively expensive. Though some initial investments may be required, the long-term economic benefits, such as reduced healthcare costs and increased energy efficiency, often outweigh the upfront costs.

Green Skill Advocate

As a young learner and future professional, you have a unique opportunity to learn green skills and contribute to the green economy.

1. **Embrace Lifelong Learning:** Stay curious and open to learning about sustainability and green practices. The more you know, the better equipped you are to make a difference.
2. **Be an Agent of Change:** Encourage sustainability in your workplace or community. Small actions, like reducing waste or promoting energy efficiency, can have a big impact.
3. **Pursue Green Careers:** Consider careers that directly align with the green economy, such as renewable energy, environmental conservation, or sustainable agriculture. But remember, green skills are relevant across all professions.
4. **Advocate for Education:** Promote the integration of green skills and sustainability into educational curricula. Advocate for more educational opportunities that focus on sustainability and its applications.
5. **Embody Sustainability:** Live a sustainable lifestyle by making conscious choices in your daily routines, from reducing plastic use to conserving energy.

Activity Time

Activity 1: Promoting Green Economy

(Pair Work)

Work with your partner to prepare a poster that communicates the significance of the green economy. Use newspaper and magazine cuttings to make your poster appear informative and creative.

Activity 2: Group Discussions

(Group Work)

Get into groups of 4–5 students and discuss the importance and benefits of green economy. Take turns to present your point of view. On an A3 size sheet of paper, summarise the points discussed by the group.

Chapter Checkup

A Select the correct option.

1. What is the primary aim of a green economy?
 - a. To maximise economic growth at any cost
 - b. To strike a balance between human well-being and economic growth while reducing environmental risks
 - c. To focus solely on environmental protection without considering economic factors
 - d. To minimise social equity for the sake of environmental preservation
2. The three pillars of a green economy are _____, _____, and _____.
 - a. low carbon, resource deficiency, and social inclusion
 - b. high carbon, resource efficiency, and social inclusion
 - c. low carbon, resource efficiency, and social inclusion
 - d. low carbon, resource efficiency, and social exclusion
3. What does the term “green” in the green economy refer to?
 - a. A colour representing waste and pollution
 - b. Sustainable and environmentally friendly practices
 - c. Economic growth without any regard for the environment
 - d. Lack of growth and innovation

B Fill in the blanks with the most suitable words.

1. The United Nations Environment Program (UNEP) defines the green economy as one that results in improved _____ and social equity.
2. The _____ emphasises using finite resources wisely.
3. Green skills encompass the _____, _____, _____ and attitudes needed to thrive in, contribute to, and promote a sustainable and resource-efficient society.
4. The transition to a green economy is expected to create more _____ in varied sectors.

C State whether the following are *True* or *False*. Correct the statements that are false.

1. The green economy focuses solely on economic growth without considering environmental risks.
2. Green skills are only relevant in specific “green” job sectors.
3. Pursuing a green career is one way to contribute to the green economy.
4. India is promoting sustainable agricultural practices to reduce its environmental impact.

D Answer the following questions. (Solved)

Q1. Explain the three pillars of green economy.

A1. The three pillars of green economy are:

- **Low Carbon Development**

This means to reduce the emission of greenhouse gases and shifting to renewable energy sources

- **Resource Efficiency**

It means to make efficient use of resources and to reduce waste. Products and services are designed for the circular economy, where materials are used for as long as possible and then recycled or reused.

- **Social Inclusion**

This includes creating new jobs, providing opportunities for training and reskilling, and supporting vulnerable communities, ensuring that everyone benefits from the transition to a green economy.

Q2. Define the term green skills.

A2. Green skills are the knowledge, abilities, values, and attitudes needed to live and flourish in, develop, and support a society that believes in preserving and conserving resources for the future through their optimal and efficient utilisation. The need to transition towards more environmentally sustainable modes of living has become a necessity, for developed as well as for developing countries.

Q3. Rohan wants to contribute to the Green Economy and promote green skills in his future career. What can he do?

A3. As a young learner and future professional, Rohan has a unique opportunity to learn green skills and contribute to the green economy.

- **Embrace Lifelong Learning:** Stay curious and open to learning about sustainability and green practices. The more you know, the better equipped you are to make a difference.
- **Be an Agent of Change:** Encourage sustainability in your workplace or community. Small actions, like reducing waste or promoting energy efficiency, can have a big impact.
- **Pursue Green Careers:** Consider careers that directly align with the green economy, such as renewable energy, environmental conservation, or sustainable agriculture. But remember, green skills are relevant across all professions.
- **Advocate for Education:** Promote the integration of green skills and sustainability into educational curricula. Advocate for more educational opportunities that focus on sustainability and its applications.
- **Embody Sustainability:** Live a sustainable lifestyle by making conscious choices in your daily routines, from reducing plastic use to conserving energy.

Answer Key

A 1. b 2. c 3. b

B 1. human well-being 2. green economy 3. knowledge, values, abilities 4. job opportunities

C 1. False. The Green Economy focuses on promoting economic growth with consideration of reducing environmental risks.
2. False. Green skills are relevant in a wide range of job sectors.
3. True.
4. True.

Unit Reflection

Key Terms

Ecosystem: An ecosystem is formed when living (plants, animals, and other organisms) and non-living components (air, water, sunlight, soil, weather, temperature etc.) interact and co-exist with each other in a physical environment.

Environment: Environment includes the surroundings or conditions in which all the living organisms exist.

Green economy: It is a kind of economy that aims to establish a system that balances human well-being and economic growth while reducing environmental risks and replenishing our resources.

Green skills: It is the knowledge, abilities, values, and attitudes needed to live and flourish in, develop, and support a society that believes in preserving and conserving the resources for the future through their optimal and efficient utilisation.

- **Natural environment:** It includes all the living (biotic) components like plants, animals, birds, and insects, and non-living (abiotic) components like water, air, soil, and sunlight, which occur naturally on Earth.
- **Man-made environment:** It includes the components and structures created by humans to satisfy their needs and requirements like buildings, houses, schools, parks, markets, roads, factories etc.

Conservation of natural resources: It is an act of protecting and managing natural resources so that everyone can benefit from them including current and future generations.

Natural resources: They are the resources drawn from nature like water, land, soil, rocks, forests, animals, fossil fuels, or minerals which are used by humans to meet their needs and requirements.

Things to Remember

- We rely heavily on the community of plants (flora) and animals (fauna) to provide us with food and other resources necessary for our survival.
- There is a strong relationship between our society and the environment. They interact and influence each other in multiple ways.
- Modifications in the environment caused by human beings have impacted our natural environment significantly.
- Industrial development and the exploitation of natural resources like extensive use of fossil fuels, deforestation etc. have created an imbalance in the environment.
- Organisms perform the diverse roles of producers, consumers, decomposers, detritivores, predators, herbivores, pollinators, and so on.
- The imbalance in the environment is caused by multiple factors like: overexploitation of resources, deforestation, pollution, overpopulation, global warming, climate change, water scarcity, and loss of biodiversity.
- The three Rs to conserve natural resources are reduce, reuse, and recycle.
- The three pillars of green economy are: low carbon, resource efficiency, and social inclusion.

- A green economy would help to mitigate climate change, reduce poverty and inequality, bring innovative technologies and advancements, ensure economic stability, create more job opportunities, and protect the environment.
- The Indian government has estimated that the green economy could create up to 50 million new jobs by 2030.
- In order to become a green skill advocate, one should embrace lifelong learning, be an agent of change, pursue green careers, advocate for education, embody sustainability.

Test Your Knowledge

A. Select the correct option.

- Which of the following is not one of the 3Rs of conservation of natural resources?
a. Reduce ☐ b. Refund ☐
c. Reuse ☐ d. Recycle ☐
- Which organisation defines a green economy as “one that results in improved human well-being and social equity while significantly reducing environmental risks and ecological scarcities”?
a. United Nations Environment Program (UNEP) ☐
b. United Nations Industrial Development Organization (UNIDO) ☐
c. United Nations Economic and Social Council (ECOSOC) ☐
d. United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) ☐
- Which organisms break down organic matter in the soil and recycle nutrients?
a. Producers ☐ b. Consumers ☐
c. Decomposers ☐ d. Predators ☐
- As a green skill advocate, you should
a. never embrace lifelong learning ☐
b. not be an agent of change ☐
c. not embody sustainability ☐
d. pursue green career ☐
- Which of the following items cannot be recycled?
a. cans ☐ b. paper products ☐
c. vegetable peels ☐ d. glass ☐

B. Fill in the blanks with the most suitable words.

- The of species due to habitat loss, pollution, climate change, and other factors can disrupt ecosystem dynamics.
- The term “green” in green economy refers to the environmentally friendly and practices it promotes.
- are the resources drawn from nature like water, land, soil, rocks, forests, animals, fossil fuels, or minerals.
- are the knowledge, abilities, values, and attitudes needed to live, flourish in, develop, and support a society that believes in preserving and conserving the resources for the future.
- There is a strong relation between our and the environment.

C. State whether the following is *True* or *False*. Correct the statements that are false.

- Trees are called life-savers as they convert the excess oxygen in the air to carbon dioxide.
- Mankind has been ungrateful to nature in its usage of natural resources.
- Red economy focuses on promoting sustainable approaches in relation to our oceans, seas, and coastal areas.
- The word “environment” comes from the French word “environ” which means “to surround”.
- The green economy creates hurdles in the sustainable use of natural resources and the protection of biodiversity.

D. Short answer-type questions.

1. Define environmental conservation. Write any two steps to conserve our environment.
2. What do you mean by green economy?
3. How is an ecosystem formed?

E. Long answer-type questions.

1. Describe a few factors which cause an imbalance in our environment.
2. List a few steps taken by India towards a green economy and achieving sustainable development.
3. How are society and the environment dependent on each other?

F. Competency-based questions.

1. Kanika is devastated by mankind's overexploitation of natural resources. She wishes to make a difference and take a step towards conservation of the natural resources. What reforms and transitions should she practise in her life to conserve natural resources?
2. Vipin doesn't understand why the government has been promoting the transition towards the green economy. He continues to operate his fabric manufacturing company using chemical dyes and deposits the contaminated water in the water bodies. His friend, Yogesh decides to explain to him the importance of the green economy. What should Yogesh tell him?